

The *Psalms*
of Advent

LONGING FOR THE MESSIAH.
SINGING HIS COMING.

ADVENT SEASON DEVOTIONS
COLONIAL PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



The *Psalm*
of Advent

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SINGING HIS COMING.

- 02 Introduction
- 04 HOPE | Pastor Todd
- 06 PEACE | Pastor Greg
- 08 JOY | Pastor Mark
- 10 LOVE | Pastor Jeff
- 12 THANKSGIVING | Pastor Julien



Dear Colonial,

This Advent season, we invite you to join us on a meaningful journey through the Psalms of Advent. Together, we'll take time to prepare our hearts for the coming of Christ by reflecting on the timeless words of Scripture. Our desire is to offer an Advent experience that can be done individually, with friends, or as a family. Rather than each ministry doing something different, we want this to be a season where the whole family comes together to grow in faith and anticipation as we celebrate the birth of our Savior.

Each Sunday during Advent, one of our pastors will preach from a psalm that highlights one of the great themes of this season – hope, peace, joy, love, and thanksgiving. Throughout the week that follows, we'll provide resources to help you continue engaging with these themes in your daily life. You'll be able to access these materials either in print or online, whichever works best for you.

Each Monday, a short devotional and reflection questions are available to help you meditate on that psalm. Tuesday offers a journaling prompt, inviting you to spend time writing and reflecting, either on your own or as a family. On Wednesday, we'll share a video devotional from one of our Colonial staff members to encourage and inspire you midweek. Thursday provides some prayer prompts to guide your quiet time with the Lord or to pray together as a family.

Friday includes a family activity and discussion questions designed to spark spiritual conversations and help you live out your faith in simple, joyful ways. And each Saturday, we offer ideas for how you can share the hope of Advent by blessing your friends and neighbors.

For a digital version of the daily advent calendar, visit ColonialKC.org/Advent.

We are truly excited for what God will do in and through this season. Our prayer is that these rhythms of worship, reflection, and connection will draw you and your family closer to Christ and to one another. So we invite you to plan on joining us this Advent season as we open the Psalms together and prepare our hearts for the coming of our King.

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jim".

- Pastor Jim West



HOPE

Psalm 2:1-12

The King We Wait For

Pastor Todd Weiland



MONDAY, DECEMBER 1

Psalm 2 offers a powerful declaration of God's promise to be our refuge, our protection in every way. Our hope rests in the powerful reign of God's Son, Jesus. Nations rage against God, but they rage in vain. God is already victorious. He has set Jesus, on the throne and no human power can overcome Christ's reign. His reign is promised, and it is unconquerable. Israel waited for God's promised Messiah...

Read Full Devotional



TUESDAY, DECEMBER 2

God, You reign above all the nations, and Your Son Jesus sits on the throne—His kingdom is unshakable. Forgive us when we stray, worry, or lack confidence in You. Help us find our safe place, in You. We trust Your promises and await the day of Jesus' return. Amen.

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 3

Devotional Video with Pastor Tami Lundgren

1. What worries or "things too great" do you need to release into God's care this Advent season?
2. When was the last time you allowed yourself to rest in God's presence like a child in a parent's arms?
3. How can you intentionally nurture a calm and hopeful heart as you wait on the Lord this week?



Scan to watch



THURSDAY, DECEMBER 4

Thank God for being your refuge, strength, and protector.

What is one area of your life that you resist God's authority? Ask Him to help you surrender that so you can trust His reign more completely.

Pray for our church to reach out to our hurting world and point people to Jesus, our refuge.

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 5

With Kids/Grandkids: Crown of Hope Family Craft.

1. Cut a paper strip to fit around your child's head.
2. Let kids decorate it with stickers, glitter, and markers. Write phrases like "Jesus is King" or "Our Hope in Christ" on it.
3. Tape or glue the ends to form a crown.
4. As you make the crown, read and talk about Psalm 2. Ask your kids what it means to take refuge in Christ.

Wear the crown during family devotions as a reminder that Jesus rules and our hope is secure.

More Activity Ideas



SATURDAY, DECEMBER 6

- Invite someone to our church's Advent worship services or our Walk To The Manager service and then discuss it over lunch afterward.
- Invite a friend/neighbor/coworker over for a meal and discussion about Advent or God's power, and then share Psalm 2 and maybe questions from this devotion.
- Help a neighbor in need, knowing you do this because Jesus reigns in your life and He calls us to serve others.



PEACE

Psalm 23:1

The Shepherd Who Restores Us

Pastor Greg Ealey



MONDAY, DECEMBER 8

Think about the complexity of billions of stars and galaxies down to the minute details of cell organisms and atoms that make up our matter and physical realm. Think about every particle that makes up the clouds and the system that uses plants to produce oxygen for us to breathe. Think about all that goes into making our world go around and our human life remain in existence. David, a young boy, sitting in the fields, gazing into the expanse of the heavens...

Read Full Devotional

QR

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 9

God, thank you for your Son Jesus who is the Prince of Peace. I praise God that I can put my faith in Him to lead me into paths of righteousness. Lord, I pray that I can show someone this peace during this advent season. In Jesus' name, Amen! Where in your life do you need peace today? Pray for God to fill that space with His peace.

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 10

Devotional Video with Torie Smith

1. Where in your life do you need to "be still and know" that God is in control?
2. How can you move from simply keeping peace to actively making peace in your relationships or community?
3. What walls of hostility might Jesus be inviting you to let Him break down this Advent season?



Scan to watch



THURSDAY, DECEMBER 11

Where in your life do you need peace today?

Pray for God to fill that space with His peace.

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 12

With Kids/Grandkids: Make Prince of Peace Cookies. You will need:

- Crown cookie cutter
- Sugar Cookie mix
- Things to decorate the crown: cranberries, dried fruit, crispy cereal, nuts, etc.

You can share the cookies with friends, family and neighbors to tell the story of Jesus our Prince of Peace.

With spouse one-to-one: What areas in your marriage do you need God to give you peace? Evaluate if peace describes your conversations with each other.

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 13

Create greeting cards with peace as the theme and hand them out to friends and neighbors.

Suggested Song: "Silent Night"

Sing this song emphasizing the peace that came with the entrance of Jesus in this world that provided a Silent and Holy night.



JOY

Psalm 98

The Song of the Redeemed

Pastor Mark Potter



MONDAY, DECEMBER 15

Psalm 98 begins with the psalmist expressing joy for all the marvelous things that God had done for the nation of Israel. Specifically, God had repeatedly demonstrated His righteousness, faithfulness, and steadfast love in bringing about their salvation, or deliverance. The words translated “steadfast love” in verse 3 come from the Hebrew word, hesed. Hesed is a word that expresses God’s covenantal loyalty, kindness, and favor....

Read Full Devotional

QR

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 16

Take a few moments to write down your own version of Psalm 98 and then pray it back to God. It could look something like this: I shout for joy at the marvelous things you have done for me! You have saved me from destruction and delivered me from my selfish desires. You have guided my path and restored my health. Thank you for the birth of Jesus, and for my salvation that comes through Him.

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 17

Devotional Video with Naomi Allen

1. Where in your life do you most need to pause (Selah) and remember that true joy is found in God’s presence?
2. How can you cultivate a deeper, lasting joy that isn’t dependent on circumstances or fleeting happiness?
3. Which verse from Psalm 16 speaks most to your heart this Advent season, and why?



Scan to watch



THURSDAY, DECEMBER 18

Pray for the people you know to experience the joy of Christ this Advent. Begin by praying for someone in your family, then one of your neighbors, co-workers, or classmates. Ask God to help you share this joy with at least one other person this week.

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 19

Find a paper towel roll or toilet paper roll to create a candle shape and cover it with pink construction paper to symbolize the joy candle. Push yellow tissue paper into the top of the cardboard roll and pull it to look like a flame. Then read the story of Jesus’ birth from Luke 2, emphasizing the joy that the shepherds felt when the angels announced the coming of the Messiah.

With spouse one-to-one: As you both reflect on Psalm 98, what is something about your spouse that brings you great joy? How could the joy of Christ overflow into other parts of your relationship?

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 20

Brainstorm something you could do for a friend or neighbor that would bring a smile to their face and point them to Christ. Delivering Christmas cookies, shoveling their driveway, etc.

Suggested Song: “Joy to the World”

Spend a minute or two researching the origin of this popular carol and then sing it together as a family.



LOVE

Psalm 103

The Faithful Covenant-Keeper

Pastor Jeff Sparks

MONDAY, DECEMBER 22

On this week of Advent, we light the candle of Love, and Psalm 103 gives that love a voice. It begins with “soul-talk”—“Bless the LORD, O my soul”—as David calls out to his own soul to remember and to anticipate. Advent is exactly that: a holy remembering that calls to our souls in anticipation of the coming Lord. We rehearse the story again because our hearts forget again. And David shows to us the nature of this summoning to remember...

Read Full Devotional

QR

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 23

“Bless the Lord, O My Soul” — Writing Your Own Soul-Talk

Psalm 103 begins with David talking to his own heart: “Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits.” Here, David proclaims that God is not deficient—and is in fact abundant—in providing us with so many benefits and blessings for praising Him. Yet, we often find ourselves focusing so much on the circumstances at the moment... Scan code for full Prayer Prompt

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 24

Devotional Video with Hannah Mabie

1. How have you experienced God’s love in moments of your own pain or uncertainty?
2. Who in your life might need you to reflect God’s love and empathy to them this Advent season?
3. What might it look like for you to slow down and truly be “with” others the way God chose to be “with us”?



Scan to watch



Scan code for full week of content

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THURSDAY, DECEMBER 25

“Love That Stoops and Adopts”

Psalm 103 shows a God who stoops—comes near to us—in His compassion and adopts us as His children in and through our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ: “As high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his love... As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear him.” Use this simple pattern to pray today: Scan code for full Prayer Prompt

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 26

Activity Option 1: “As High / As Far” Gratitude Night

Theme: God’s love is higher than the heavens and removes our sin “as far as the east is from the west.”

1. Prepare:
 - On one sheet of paper, draw a big arrow pointing up and write, “As high as the heavens...”
 - On another, draw a long arrow from left to right and write, “As far as the east is from the west...” Scan code for full all activities

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 27

Activity Option 1: “Compassion Cards” for Neighbors

Theme: “As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion...” (Psalm 103:13)

1. Choose 1–3 households on your street, in your building, or in your regular orbit (teacher, coach, barista, etc.).
2. As a family or small group of friends, create simple handwritten cards that say something like: “This Advent, we’re praying you would know how deeply God loves you.” Scan code for full all activities



THANKSGIVING

Psalm 145

The God Who Is Worthy of All Praise

Pastor Julien de Leiris



MONDAY, DECEMBER 29

Psalm 145 reminds us that God is worthy of all praise. His greatness is beyond measure, and every generation is called to tell of His mighty acts and proclaim His faithfulness. In Matthew 2, the wise men echo this truth. When they saw the star, they rejoiced with great joy and bowed before the newborn King, offering costly gifts of worship. Their thanksgiving flowed from hearts full of awe and gratitude. As we close the year...

Read Full Devotional

QR

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 30

Lord Jesus, You are the King of kings and worthy of all thanksgiving. Like the wisemen, help me to offer You the best of my heart and life. May my worship be more than words. Let it become a life of gratitude, service, and generosity to You. Amen.

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 31

Devotional Video with Amber Gutshall

1. When has God “lifted you out of the pit,” and how can remembering that deepen your gratitude today?
2. What does your current “lifesong” — your words, priorities, and actions — reveal about what matters most to you?
3. How can you share your story of God’s goodness with others in a simple, authentic way this Advent season?



Scan to watch



THURSDAY, JANUARY 1

Thank God for His greatest gift: Christ Himself.

Ask the Holy Spirit to show you one area of your life to dedicate as an offering this year.

Pray that our church family would live with open hands, expressing thanksgiving through sacrificial generosity and service.

FRIDAY, JANUARY 2

With Kids / Grandkids: Gift Box for Jesus. Create a simple box together and invite each child to place a note or drawing inside, representing something they want to give to Jesus this year (helping at home, showing kindness, or praying more faithfully). On Epiphany (January 6), open the box together and pray, thanking Jesus for His love and dedicating your family’s gifts to Him.

SATURDAY, JANUARY 3

Write one short note or message of thanks to someone outside your family who encouraged you this year. Let it be a simple expression of gratitude that points back to God’s goodness.

Suggested Song:

Great Is Thy Faithfulness
Here I Am to Worship

More Activity Ideas

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WALK TO THE MANGER 2025

The 35th annual nativity musical production.



DEC 7 @ OP | 8:00, 9:30, & 11:00AM
DEC 14 @ SKC | 9:00 & 10:45AM

Gifts and monetary donations will be accepted to support local and international ministries.

Gift Lists & Donate:
ColonialKC.org/Give



JOIN US FOR CHRISTMAS EVE AT COLONIAL!

DECEMBER 24, 2025

Overland Park Campus

12501 W 137th St, Overland Park, KS 66221

1:00, 3:00, & 7:00PM

South Kansas City Campus

9500 Wornall, Kansas City, MO 64114

4:30PM

Online @ 3:00PM

